

SSSSSSSSSS ADMINS

THERE ARE VIRTUAL GATEKEEPERS SITTING ON YOUR NETWORK TRAFFIC RIGHT NOW. BUT SYSTEM ADMINISTRATORS ARE NOT AS BULLETPROOF AS THEY MIGHT SEEM!

BY ARNAB MUKHERJEE
arnab@digit.in



Remember when you quickly went on to Facebook while on a coffee break at work? How about that time you

opened up a Torrent site in the college computer lab? You thought you got away with it and no one noticed? You're probably wrong, because System Administrators or sys-admins (or sss-admins – because people compare them to snakes) see everything! They're not too liked because of how rigid they can be.

Remember, though, don't hate the person, hate the position, because he or she is just doing their job. That disclaimer aside, it's time to learn how to stick it to them! Remember, though there can be serious consequences for such actions, and losing your job, or even prosecution and jailtime might be on the cards, depending on where you work. Plus, if you happen to be an actual sys-admin, this article might help you learn how people are bypassing your restrictions. Now that

we've saved our collective backsides from lawsuits, on with the article!

THE RESTRICTIONS

Sys-admins are a bunch of tools. No, that came out wrong, what we meant was that they use a bunch of tools. First step in bypassing the tools is leaning about them yourself:

- **Network firewalls** – These block incoming and outgoing access to whatever the sss-admin wants to block – websites and IP addresses.
- **Installation access** – If you're unable to install or upgrade things on your system this is because of restrictions on installations.
- **Process list** – You may be barred from being able to view or change the current running processes on your system.
- **Blocked ports** – You may be barred from accessing certain TCP/IP ports which some services might require to be open in order to run.

There might be a few other restrictions in place as well, but they will be similar to the ones we've mentioned

here, and you can bypass most with the knowledge you get from this article.

EMBRACE YOUR SNAKEHOOD

While most sys-admins try and lock you out of the important settings of your computer, here's how you can lock them out instead:

If you're on Windows, just restart your computer. When you get to the 'Starting Windows' screen, hold down the power button on your PC/Laptop to shut it down again. Start it again and you should be at the Windows Error Recovery screen. Choose Launch Startup Repair and let the repair go through (if the System Restore dialog pops up, hit [Cancel]). When you get to the screen that says Startup repair cannot repair this computer automatically, click on 'Show problem details' and scroll to the bottom and click on the last link, which is when Notepad should pop up. Go to File > Open and open the local disk (C:/ in almost all cases). Go to Windows/System32.